AFRICAN SOLIDARITY CIVIC ORGANISATION (ASCO)

Registered NPC: 2026/521895/08 | Tax Reference: 9322812265
SARS PBO Exemption: 930092287 | Section 18A Approved
49 Rif Road, Manor Gardens

Durban, KwaZulu-Natal

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ASCO STRATEGIC PLAN 2027–2029

October 2026 Edition

AFRICAN SOLIDARITY CIVIC ORGANISATION NPC (ASCO NPC)

CIPC Registration No.: 2026/521895/08 | SARS Income Tax Reference: 9322812265 | SARS PBO Reference: 930092287

Updated: 27 October 2026 — SARS PBO and Section 18A approval status harmonised from the approval letter dated 26 October 2026.

Status: ASCO is an approved Public Benefit Organisation. Section 18A approval is effective 9 October 2026. This Plan does not authorise Section 18A receipts or claim tax deductibility subject to the SARS approval and receipt-control requirements.

1. Strategic Context

ASCO enters 2027–2029 as an approved Public Benefit Organisation committed to African solidarity, human dignity, constitutionalism, social justice, peace, community development, environmental responsibility and sustainable development. The Board governs; Executive Management manages.

2. Governance and Leadership

ASCO has exactly four Directors: Ms Busisiwe Makhosi Shandu — Chairperson / Founder; Mr Bhekisisa Shandu — Executive Director; Mr Thapelo Nelson Maqalika — Director: ICT and Communications; and Mr Khulekani Gumede — Director: People and Culture / Chairperson: Finance and Procurement. Senior non-director leadership positions are Treasurer & Finance Officer; Ms Angel Nokukhanya Gumede — Head of Humanitarian Affairs & Emergency Response; Mr Maguqu Meshack Mzimela — Head of Programmes, Research & Strategic Partnerships; and Ms Thando Mathe — Head of Social Protection, Inclusion & Safeguarding.

3. Strategic Priorities

- Section 18A compliance, controlled receipt issuance and accurate donor communications.
- Programme expansion in civic education, youth development, social cohesion, humanitarian action, community development, gender and inclusion, disability inclusion and environmental sustainability.

- Institutional sustainability through strong financial controls, safeguarding, POPIA/PAIA compliance, risk management and impact reporting.
- Donor diversification, corporate partnerships and responsible international partnerships without compromising ASCO independence.
- Environmental programme expansion and SDG-aligned programming supported by evidence and community participation.

4. Environmental Programme Record

Operation Protect Our Aquatic Ecosystem was completed at Richards Bay Beachfront, King Cetshwayo District, KwaZulu-Natal, on 22 September 2026. Activities included environmental awareness, beachfront cleanup, community/environmental action and protection of the aquatic environment. Sponsored by SPAR Empangeni. No unverified participant, waste or beneficiary figures are included.

5. Programme Approach

ASCO will use Board-approved plans, safeguarding measures, proportionate monitoring and evaluation, community feedback, documented partnerships and accurate financial and programme records. Planning targets are not represented as completed results.

6. Resource Mobilisation and Partnerships

ASCO will pursue donor diversification, corporate CSI, foundations, institutional grants, responsible sponsorships and international partnerships aligned with its public-benefit objectives. Donor restrictions, conflicts, source documentation, restricted funds and reporting will be managed under the approved donation procedures.

7. 2027–2029 Outcomes

Priority outcomes include strengthened governance and compliance; expanded community participation; improved programme learning and impact evidence; responsible environmental action; stronger youth, gender and disability inclusion; increased institutional sustainability; and broader mission-aligned partnerships.

8. Review and Accountability

The Executive Director coordinates implementation and reporting. The Board reviews progress, risks, financial performance and material changes at least annually. The Plan may be updated through a recorded Board process and must remain consistent with the MOI, Constitution, Board Charter, approved policies and applicable law.

9. Contact

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BOARD ADOPTION AND SIGNATURES

This Strategic Plan is a final Board adoption instrument. The signatures below record Board adoption/acknowledgement. They do not alter the four-Director legal structure or create financial authority for the Founder/Founding Chairperson.

CHAIR LADY **Ms. Busisiwe Makhosi Shandu** Signature: _____ Date: **2 October 2026**	**DIRECTOR: HEAD OF ICT AND COMMUNICATIONS** **Mr. Thapelo Nelson Maqalika** Signature: _____ Date: **2 October 2026**
EXECUTIVE DIRECTOR **Mr. Bhekisisa Shandu** Signature: _____ Date: **2 October 2026**	**DIRECTOR: PEOPLE AND CULTURE / CHAIRPERSON: FINANCE AND PROCUREMENT COMMITTEE** **Mr. Khulekani Gumede** Signature: _____ Date: **2 October 2026**